

January 12, 2026 and set for hearing on June 29, 2026 (the “Motion to Bifurcate Discovery”).
The hearing date on the Motion to Bifurcate Discovery is VACATED. The International Church will not be heard on such matters while it stands in a posture of non-compliance and contempt of the Court’s prior discovery order. See *MacPherson v. MacPherson* (1939) 13 Cal.2d 271, 277 (“A party to an action cannot, with right or reason, ask the aid and assistance of a court in hearing his demands while he stands in an attitude of contempt to legal orders and processes of the courts of this state.”).

5. The Court shall issue the order after hearing.

6. 9:00 AM CASE NUMBER: C24-01939
CASE NAME: NICKOLAI POPOV VS. ALEXANDER POPOV
***HEARING ON MOTION IN RE: SET ASIDE & VACATE JUDGMENT OF DISMISSAL ON THE GROUNDS OF UNDUE INFLUENCE & LACK OF CAPACITY**
FILED BY:
TENTATIVE RULING:

See line 7.

7. 9:00 AM CASE NUMBER: C24-01939
CASE NAME: NICKOLAI POPOV VS. ALEXANDER POPOV
***HEARING ON MOTION IN RE: STAY.**
FILED BY:
TENTATIVE RULING:

At the hearing on August 04, 2025, the Court continued this motion until after the probate hearing regarding the administrator of the Estate of Nickolai Popov on August 25, 2025, and ordered additional briefing. The Court thanks the Parties who submitted their additional briefs and will not be taking any more additional briefing from the Parties at this time.

On September 11, 2025, Counsel for Defendant Alexander Popov filed a status update for Probate Case No: P25-00516. The status update requested a continuance of a hearing date from the Probate Court for the Parties to coordinate mediation for a global settlement of all four related cases (C25-00229; C24-01939; P25-00516; and P25-00495) which was set to take place on October 15, 2025.

The Probate Court in a minute order dated September 25, 2025, continued the Motion to Set Aside the Appointment of Special Administrator to December 16, 2025.

The Probate Court granted a temporary order assigning Michael Popov as Special Administrator due to the original order being set to expire and continued the Motion to Set Aside the Appointment of Special Administrator to January 27, 2026.

In the name of judicial efficiency, the Court is going to continue this hearing to March 16, 2026, at 9:00 AM in this department, to ensure no conflicting rulings are issued.

8. 9:00 AM CASE NUMBER: C24-02590
CASE NAME: NEXTGEAR CAPITAL, INC. VS. FARHAD AMINZADA
HEARING ON SUMMARY MOTION
FILED BY: NEXTGEAR CAPITAL, INC.
TENTATIVE RULING:

The Court continues the hearing on this motion to February 23, 2026, at 9:00 a.m.

9. 9:00 AM CASE NUMBER: C25-00549
CASE NAME: JESUS MUNGUIA VS. LAS MONTANAS MARKET, INC.
***HEARING ON MOTION IN RE: TO BE RELIEVED AS COUNSEL**
FILED BY: MUNGUIA, JESUS
TENTATIVE RULING:

Fletcher B. Brown (“Counsel”) filed a Motion to be Relieved as Counsel on September 10, 2025 (the “Motion to be Relieved as Counsel”). The matter was set for hearing on January 26, 2026.

Background

Counsel seeks to be relieved as attorneys for plaintiff Jesus Munguia (“Client”).

The supporting declaration filed by Counsel indicates that Counsel “CAN NO LONGER EFFECTIVELY PROSECUTE THIS CASE” such that Counsel’s withdrawal is necessary. See Declaration filed September 10, 2025, ¶2. Counsel’s Client has been given notice of the Motion to be Relieved as Counsel. *Id.* at ¶3.

Analysis

The Motion to be Relieved as Counsel is unopposed.

Disposition

The Court finds and rules as follows:

1. The Motion to be Relieved as Counsel is GRANTED.
2. The Court shall issue the order after hearing.

10. 9:00 AM CASE NUMBER: C25-01030
CASE NAME: SPRING DAUGHTRY VS. PAULA TINT
***HEARING ON MOTION IN RE: FOR LEAVE TO INTERVENE**
FILED BY: CENTRAL CONTRA COSTA TRANSIT AUTHORITY
TENTATIVE RULING:

Third party and proposed intervenor Central Contra Costa Transit Authority (“Intervenor”) filed a Motion for Leave to Intervene on September 9, 2025 (the “Motion for Leave to Intervene”). The Motion for Leave to Intervene was set for hearing on January 26, 2026. The motion was duly served.

Background

Intervenor recites that it is the employer of plaintiff Spring Daughtry, and due to his work-related